30.6 to 27 per cent. So, voters are noticing the effort, it's just that they are simply not making the next big leap in large numbers—from 'Rahul is doing a good job' to 'Rahul should be prime minister'.

Inside the Congress, though, there is much less ambiguity. Rahul's position has strengthened as 40.5 per cent say he is best suited to lead the party, up from 35.6 per cent in January. Priyanka Gandhi is at 7.3 per cent, Sachin Pilot at 7, Shashi Tharoor at 3.2 and Mallikarjun Kharge at 1.9.

MIXED REPORT CARD

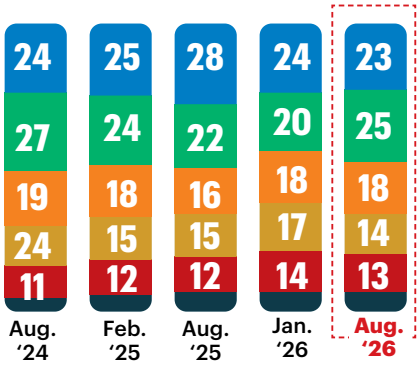
The party's report card is more mixed. On the Congress's performance as an Opposition party, 40.6 per cent rate it 'outstanding' or 'good', almost unchanged from January's 41 per cent. The combined 'poor/very poor' score has eased from 33.1 to 31.6 per cent. A majority, 56.6 per cent, says Congress is the 'real Opposition party', slightly higher than January's 55.2 per cent, though well below the 66.4 per cent noted in August '25.

The INDIA bloc question sharpens the contradiction. A combined 58 per cent



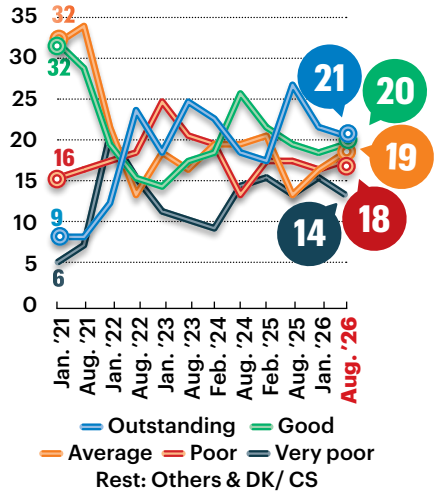
PTI

Q. How would you assess Rahul Gandhi's performance as Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha?



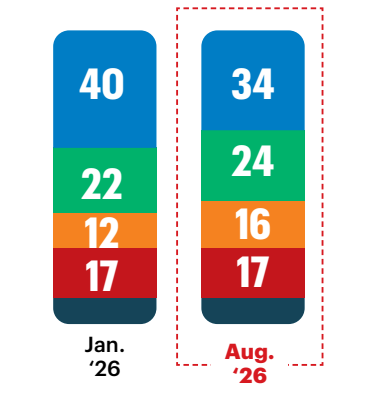
A 4% jump in approval for the Congress leader's strident stand

Q. How would you rate the Congress as an Opposition party?



The grand ol' party stays steady, but can't break new ground

Q. Is Congress the weak link in the INDIA bloc?



Some 58% still think the Congress is the weak link

All figures in % and rounded off; DK/ CS: Don't know/ can't say